



Denis Yarats

Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer

2022

Founded

~1,400

Employees (est.)

~\$450M+

ARR

~\$20B

Valuation

780M

Monthly queries

01 Who You're Meeting

Denis Yarats — Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, Perplexity.

The company: Went from a \$121M valuation in April 2023 to roughly \$20B by September 2025, on annualised revenue reported above \$450M by March 2026. The strategic bet is Comet — a free agentic browser — on the thesis that owning the browsing surface beats owning the underlying model.

What they sell: An answer engine returning synthesised, cited answers rather than links, sold through a free tier, Pro at \$20/month, Max at \$200/month, enterprise plans, an API, and a publisher revenue-share programme. Comet, a Chromium-based agentic browser, went free worldwide in October 2025. Deep Research provides asynchronous multi-step research.

02 Where The Company Sits

Perplexity does not train frontier models; it buys inference from Anthropic, OpenAI and open-weight providers and competes on interface, citation discipline and distribution. That is a real product advantage for research-shaped work — compare X to Y, what does this paper say — and a structural vulnerability, because its suppliers are also its competitors and its valuation is priced where foundation labs trade.

03 What To Pressure-Test

- Buys most frontier inference from Anthropic, OpenAI and open-weight providers — its suppliers are also its competitors
- Valued at roughly 40 to 100 times ARR depending on which figures are used, priced where foundation labs trade despite not training frontier models
- Active publisher lawsuits over content scraping are unresolved and material to enterprise adoption
- Website visits declined from their November 2025 peak; it has not dented Google's 90%+ search share

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. Relevance sits in the Individual Productivity area of the reference model — research and analysis workflows — rather than asset optimisation. Note that active publisher litigation over content scraping is a live consideration for any enterprise deployment.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship.

Others at Perplexity: Aravind Srinivas (Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer)